

Technology

62 words · Technology

NOUNS

device

a piece of electronic equipment such as a phone, tablet, or laptop

She forgot her device at home and couldn't check her emails.

software

programs and operating systems used by a computer

The software needs updating. It's running very slowly.

update

a new version of software that improves or fixes the existing version

There's a system update available. You should install it.

algorithm

a set of rules a computer follows to solve a problem or complete a task

The recommendation algorithm learns from what you watch.

cache

temporary data stored to speed up access to frequently used content

Clearing the cache sometimes fixes loading problems.

server

a computer that provides data and services to other computers on a network

The server crashed, taking the whole website down with it.

notification

an automatic alert from an app or system about new activity

He turned off all his notifications to focus on work.

backup

a copy of data stored separately in case the original is lost

Always keep a backup of important files.

app

a software application, especially one downloaded onto a phone

There's an app for almost everything these days.

battery

the power source in a portable device

My battery is nearly dead. Have you got a charger?

chatbot

a computer program designed to have text or voice conversations with a user

I asked the chatbot to explain the contract in plain English before I signed anything.

browser

a program used to access and navigate the internet

She cleared her browser history and cache.

interface

the visual layout through which a user interacts with software

The new interface is much cleaner and easier to navigate.

platform

a software environment or online service on which applications run

The platform launched a new creator monetisation scheme.

glitch

a small software or hardware fault causing unexpected behaviour

There was a glitch in the checkout process and the payment failed.

subscription

a recurring payment for access to a digital service

She cancelled her subscription after the price went up.

OTP

a one-time password; a single-use code sent to verify your identity

Enter the OTP that was sent to your phone to complete the login.

cybersecurity

the practice of protecting systems and networks from digital attacks

The company invested heavily in cybersecurity after the data breach.

cloud computing

the delivery of computing services over the internet rather than local hardware

Most of their infrastructure has moved to cloud computing.

artificial intelligence

computer systems able to perform tasks that normally require human intelligence

Artificial intelligence is transforming how we interact with technology.

machine learning

a branch of AI where systems learn from data without being explicitly programmed

The spam filter uses machine learning to improve over time.

ADJECTIVES

online

connected to the internet; happening over the internet

She does most of her shopping online now.

laggy

slow to respond, especially due to a weak connection or overloaded system

The game was really laggy. The connection couldn't handle it.

wireless

using radio waves rather than cables to transmit data

The whole building has wireless internet access.

AI-generated

produced by artificial intelligence rather than created directly by a person

It's getting harder to tell AI-generated art from something a human actually painted.

VERBS

download

to transfer data from the internet to your device

He downloaded the app and set it up in five minutes.

stream

to watch or listen to media content over the internet without downloading it

They streamed the concert live from their living room.

crash

(of software or hardware) to stop working suddenly

The app kept crashing every time she tried to open it.

scroll

to move up or down through content on a screen

She scrolled through her feed for twenty minutes without realising.

upload

to transfer data from your device to the internet or a server

She uploaded the photos to the shared folder.

hack

to gain unauthorised access to a computer system

Someone tried to hack into her email account.

sync

to ensure data is identical across multiple devices or platforms

Your contacts sync automatically across all your devices.

lurk

to read or observe an online space without actively participating

Not really. I mostly just lurk. I prefer reading to posting.

PHRASAL VERBS

log in

to enter your username and password to access a system or account

I couldn't log in because I'd forgotten my password.

plug in

to connect a device to a power supply or another device

Plug in the charger and leave it overnight.

sign up

to register for an online account or service

She signed up for the newsletter and immediately regretted it.

back up

to make a copy of data to prevent it from being lost

Make sure you back up your files before updating the system.

cut out

(of a signal or connection) to stop suddenly and unexpectedly

The call kept cutting out. The signal was terrible.

roll out

to gradually release a new product, feature, or update to users

The update will be rolled out to all users over the next two weeks.

log out

to end a session by signing out of a system

Always log out when using a shared computer.

set up

to install and configure a device or application

It took him about ten minutes to set up the new router.

get round to

to find the time to do something, after a delay

Too many. I keep meaning to cancel half of them but never get round to it.

switch off

to turn off a device; also to stop thinking about work and relax

She found it impossible to switch off in the evenings.

take over

to assume control of something, replacing what was there before

Are you worried about AI taking over jobs?

opt out

to choose not to participate in a system or data-sharing agreement

You can opt out of data collection in the privacy settings.

COLLOCATIONS

lose signal

to lose mobile or internet connectivity

We kept losing signal as the train went through the tunnel.

driving me mad

making me very frustrated

My laptop keeps crashing. It's driving me mad.

digital detox

a period of deliberately avoiding all electronic devices and screens

She did a full digital detox for a week and said it changed her life.

highlight reel

a curated selection of only someone's best or most impressive moments, especially online

Remember you're comparing your everyday life to someone else's highlight reel.

run out of battery

(of a device) to have no power remaining

Her phone ran out of battery just as they were trying to find the address.

go viral

to spread rapidly and widely on the internet

The video went viral overnight and had ten million views by morning.

force a reconnect

to make a device establish a new connection, usually to fix a signal problem

It sometimes forces a reconnect.

IDIOMS

glued to your phone

completely absorbed in looking at your phone,
unable to put it down

He's been glued to his phone all evening, scrolling through the same three apps.

SET PHRASES

pretty much

more or less, almost entirely, a very common
informal qualifier

Pretty much. It means I can access my files from any device.

correct me if I'm wrong, but

used to politely introduce a point that questions
what someone has said

Correct me if I'm wrong, but people have been saying that for years.

there's something to be said for

used to point out that something has real merit,
even if it isn't the obvious choice

There's something to be said for writing things down by hand.

turn on/off

to switch a device off and back on again, often to
fix a fault

Try turning aeroplane mode on and off. It sometimes forces a reconnect.

by all accounts

according to what most people say, although not
from personal experience

By all accounts, yes, though I only saw it mentioned once myself.

MODERN SLANG

ghost

to suddenly stop responding to someone online
without explanation

He ghosted her after three months of messaging.

catfish

to create a fake online identity to deceive others

She was catfished by someone pretending to be a photographer.

doomscroll

to compulsively scroll through negative news or
social media

She found herself doomscrolling late into the night.

lurker

someone who reads or watches an online group
or forum without ever posting themselves

There are thousands of members in the group, but most of them are just lurkers.